The Curtain Falls

1. Shortly before the Politburo meeting, union boss Harry Tisch had traveled to Moscow and informed Mikhail Gorbachev of the plan to remove Honecker. The chairman of the CPSU wished the company every success – sealing the fate of Erich Honecker.

2. Honecker Cross Examined . p.11

3. Hans-Hermann Hertle and Gerd-Rüdiger Stephan. Das Ende der SED: Die letzten Tage des Zentralkomitees (Links, 1997). p.52.

4. Ibid. p.12

5. Ibid. p.170

6. Honecker Resignation Statement. SED handout, via ADN. 18 October 1989.

7. Bild . 19 October 1989

8. FAZ. 19 October 1989

9. BStU. MfS, Berlin, XV, Number: 49

10. Reading Evening Post . 19 October 1989

11. Interview with Ambassador Richard C. Barkley. Library of Congress. Frontline Diplomacy, Manuscript Division

12. Ibid